

D037

Practicum in Educational Leadership

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A veteran teacher who coaches the winning debate team has arrived 20 minutes late three times this month, leaving a class uncovered. Nothing about lateness is in the teacher's file. The teacher is popular with families. As the administrative intern, what should you recommend to your cooperating principal as the first step?

- A. Meet with the teacher, state the expectation and the dates, hear the explanation, and document the conversation.
- B. Recommend non-renewal, since leaving students uncovered is always grounds for dismissal.
- C. Let it go this time because of the teacher's value to the debate program.
- D. Place the teacher on a formal improvement plan right away.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An employee's file shows a documented verbal warning and a written warning for the same issue, and the problem continues. Which step most likely comes next?

- A. Immediate termination without a meeting.
- B. A peer mentoring pairing, which replaces the discipline process.
- C. Another verbal warning to keep the relationship positive.
- D. A formal improvement plan with specific goals, supports, and a timeline.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

After a 30-minute visit to a seventh-grade science class with new lab tables, an intern writes feedback for a post-conference. The room was recently painted and the teacher has taught for 15 years. Which note best fits an evidence-based observation cycle?

- A. "Great energy and clearly an experienced teacher."
- B. "Six of 24 students answered questions; all were in the front row. Rubric area: engagement. Next step: try cold-call sticks."
- C. "The lesson was boring and students were checked out."
- D. "The room looks much better; keep the labs tidy."

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A high school with a new cafeteria and 1,100 students is building next year's master schedule. AP Physics has only one section, and a reading intervention class must meet daily for 42 students. Several teachers asked for no first-period classes. What should be placed first?

- A. The single AP Physics section and the daily reading intervention sections.
- B. Large-enrollment electives, since they serve the most students.
- C. Lunch periods for the new cafeteria.
- D. The teacher requests for no first-period classes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A middle school is \$40,000 short on the cost of its required core math teacher. The school has an unspent federal grant that must go to extra services for struggling learners. The district finance office is moving to new software this spring. What is the right use of the grant money?

- A. Hold the grant until the new software is running.
- B. Any grant money can be used as long as it helps students.
- C. Fund added help beyond the core program, such as after-school tutoring, and cover the core teacher with local funds.
- D. Use the grant to pay the core math teacher's salary.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A school has a restricted federal grant for extra support for struggling learners. Which use is allowed?

- A. The salary of a required core classroom teacher.
- B. Anything the principal approves in writing.
- C. A summer reading program the school does not otherwise offer.
- D. Required state testing materials for all students.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

At 1:15 p.m., during a well-attended spring assembly, the county sends an alert that a chemical tanker has leaked on the highway two miles upwind. The assembly was planned for months. Which protocol fits?

- A. Evacuate everyone to the football field.
- B. Shelter in place: move everyone indoors, close windows, and shut off outside air intake.
- C. Lockdown with lights off and doors locked.
- D. Finish the assembly, then decide.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Staff are told to lock doors, turn off lights, and keep students out of sight. What kind of event is this protocol meant for?

- A. A violent threat in or near the building.
- B. Any emergency at all.
- C. A tornado warning.
- D. A fire in the science wing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A hiring panel meets in the renovated library to fill a fourth-grade opening that drew 30 applicants. One panelist wants to add: “Do you plan to have kids soon?” Which approach is best?

- A. Keep it, since with so many applicants the panel needs a way to narrow the pool.
- B. Keep the question but ask it only to some candidates.
- C. Drop the question and ask every candidate the same job-related questions scored on a shared rubric.
- D. Let each panelist ask whatever helps judge fit.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A special education teacher resigns in October, and a replacement cannot start until January. The school is also piloting a new reading program. To cover the gap, one administrator suggests cutting a student's IEP pull-out time from 5 hours to 2 hours a week. What is the correct response?

- A.** Reduce to 2 hours and note the staffing reason in the file.
- B.** Keep providing the 5 hours through other qualified staff or contracted help; any change requires an IEP team meeting.
- C.** Tell the parent about the cut after the fact.
- D.** Place the student in the reading pilot instead.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An IEP team, including the parent, agrees at a meeting to reduce a student's services because goals were met. Who made the decision, and is it valid?

- A.** Only the principal can approve service changes, so it is not valid.
- B.** It is valid only after the district budget office signs off.
- C.** It is not valid, because services can never be reduced.
- D.** The IEP team made it, so it is a valid change.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A principal who wants to raise test scores plans to add a daily 20-minute tutoring duty for all teachers starting Monday. The staff lounge was just updated. What should the intern check first?

- A.** Nothing; administrators may assign any duty.
- B.** Last year's test scores to justify the change.
- C.** The student handbook.
- D.** The collective bargaining agreement's terms on duty time and notice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A veteran teacher ~~who coaches the winning debate team~~ has arrived 20 minutes late three times this month, leaving a class uncovered. Nothing about lateness is in the teacher's file. ~~The teacher is popular with families.~~ As the administrative intern, what should you recommend to your cooperating principal as the first step?

Target word: first step in addressing a new conduct problem **Decides:** No prior documentation, so the process starts at the first step with notice.

A	Correct	Progressive discipline begins with clear notice, a chance to respond, and documentation.
B	Absolute language	Jumps to the harshest step with no prior notice or documentation.
C	Camouflage	Coaching success does not change the duty to address uncovered classes.
D	Dropped element	Skips the earlier notice steps; nothing is on file yet.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

An employee's file shows a documented verbal warning and a written warning for the same issue, and the problem continues. Which step most likely comes next?

Target word: next step after two documented steps **Decides:** Earlier steps are complete; the next step is a formal improvement plan.

A	Dropped element	Removes notice and the chance to respond.
B	Adjacent category	Support can be part of a plan but does not replace the process.
C	Inverted operation	Moves backward in the sequence after steps already failed.
D	Correct	Escalates one step with clear expectations and a chance to improve.

3. Answer B Concept 2

After a 30-minute visit to a seventh-grade science class ~~with new lab tables~~, an intern writes feedback for a post-conference. ~~The room was recently painted and the teacher has taught for 15 years.~~ Which note best fits an evidence-based observation cycle?

Target word: quality of observation feedback **Decides:** Low-inference evidence tied to a rubric with a next step.

A	Camouflage	Reacts to experience, not evidence of practice.
B	Correct	Records what was seen, links it to the rubric, and gives a next step.
C	Confusion set	Opinion and inference, not observable evidence.
D	Adjacent category	Comments on facilities, not instruction.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A high school ~~with a new cafeteria and 1,100 students~~ is building next year's master schedule. AP Physics has only one section, and a reading intervention class must meet daily for 42 students. Several teachers asked for no first-period classes. What should be placed first?

Target word: scheduling order **Decides:** Singleton and required intervention sections go first.

A	Correct	Placing constrained, student-need sections first prevents unfixable conflicts.
B	Adjacent category	Multi-section courses are flexible and can be placed around singletons.
C	Camouflage	The cafeteria detail does not set priority for courses.
D	Inverted operation	Puts adult preference ahead of student need.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A middle school is \$40,000 short on the cost of its required core math teacher. The school has an unspent federal grant that must go to extra services for struggling learners. ~~The district finance office is moving to new software this spring.~~ What is the right use of the grant money?

Target word: allowed use of restricted funds **Decides:** Restricted funds must supplement, not replace, required core costs.

A	Camouflage	The software change does not decide what the money can buy.
B	Absolute language	Restricted funds carry specific rules on use.
C	Correct	The grant adds services; the required core cost stays on local funds.
D	Confusion set	Replaces money the school must spend anyway; that is supplanting.

6. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A school has a restricted federal grant for extra support for struggling learners. Which use is allowed?

Target word: allowed use — reversed from the violation **Decides:** The service must be added beyond what the school must already provide.

A	Inverted operation	Replaces required local spending; that is supplanting.
B	Absolute language	Approval does not change the grant's restrictions.
C	Correct	Adds a service beyond the required program.
D	Confusion set	Required costs must be covered with regular funds.

7. Answer B Concept 5

At 1:15 p.m., ~~during a well-attended spring assembly~~, the county sends an alert that a chemical tanker has leaked on the highway two miles upwind. ~~The assembly was planned for months.~~ Which protocol fits?

Target word: protocol for an outside air hazard **Decides:** The hazard is outside and airborne.

A	Inverted operation	Moves people toward the hazard; evacuation is for dangers inside.
B	Correct	An outside environmental hazard calls for staying inside and sealing the building.
C	Confusion set	Lockdown is for a violent threat, not an air hazard.
D	Camouflage	The event's planning does not change the response to a hazard.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

Staff are told to lock doors, turn off lights, and keep students out of sight. What kind of event is this protocol meant for?

Target word: hazard type from the protocol **Decides:** Lock, lights off, out of sight = lockdown for a violent threat.

A	Correct	Lockdown hides and secures people from an intruder.
B	Absolute language	Each protocol matches a specific type of hazard.
C	Adjacent category	Severe weather calls for sheltering in interior spaces, not hiding from a person.
D	Confusion set	Fire requires evacuation.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A hiring panel ~~meets in the renovated library~~ to fill a fourth-grade opening ~~that drew 30 applicants~~. One panelist wants to add: "Do you plan to have kids soon?" Which approach is best?

Target word: sound interview practice **Decides:** Family plans are a protected area; questions must be job-related and consistent.

A	Camouflage	Pool size does not make a protected-trait question acceptable.
B	Dropped element	Still asks a protected-trait question, and now inconsistently.
C	Correct	Structured, job-related, consistent questions are fair and lawful.
D	Adjacent category	Unstructured fit questions drift into bias and unrelated topics.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A special education teacher resigns in October, and a replacement cannot start until January. ~~The school is also piloting a new reading program.~~ To cover the gap, one administrator suggests cutting a student's IEP pull-out time from 5 hours to 2 hours a week. What is the correct response?

Target word: who may change IEP services **Decides:** Services must match the IEP; changes need an IEP team decision.

A	Inverted operation	Lets staffing drive the IEP instead of the IEP driving staffing.
B	Correct	The school must deliver the IEP as written.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out the IEP team, including the parent, from the decision.
D	Camouflage	The pilot does not replace services written in the IEP.

11. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

An IEP team, including the parent, agrees at a meeting to reduce a student's services because goals were met. Who made the decision, and is it valid?

Target word: validity of a change — reversed from the problem **Decides:** The IEP team with the parent made it.

A	Confusion set	Service decisions are the team's, not one administrator's.
B	Adjacent category	Budget does not decide what a student needs.
C	Absolute language	Services can change when the team decides based on data.
D	Correct	Changes in services are the team's decision.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A principal ~~who wants to raise test scores~~ plans to add a daily 20-minute tutoring duty for all teachers starting Monday. ~~The staff lounge was just updated.~~ What should the intern check first?

Target word: first check before changing duties **Decides:** Duty time is a working condition set by the negotiated agreement.

A	Absolute language	Authority is limited by the negotiated agreement.
B	Camouflage	The goal does not settle whether the change is allowed.
C	Adjacent category	Governs students, not staff working conditions.
D	Correct	Contract terms govern changes to working conditions.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Progressive discipline and due process	Personnel concerns move through documented, escalating steps (verbal notice, written warning, improvement plan, formal action), and the employee gets clear notice and a chance to respond at each step.	Jumping to the harshest consequence because the leader is frustrated or the issue feels obvious.	A first or early performance or conduct problem and a question about the next step.
2	Evidence-based observation cycle	A supervisory observation uses a pre-conference, low-inference evidence during the visit, and a post-conference where feedback ties evidence to the agreed rubric and a next step.	Writing opinions (“the lesson was boring”) instead of what was seen and heard.	Notes from a classroom visit and a question about quality of the feedback.
3	Master schedule priorities	Build the master schedule around student needs first: place singleton and required intervention sections before flexible sections and adult preferences.	Starting with staff requests or last year's grid and fitting students in afterward.	A scheduling conflict between a course only offered once and a more flexible course or preference.
4	Supplement, not supplant	Restricted categorical funds (such as federal Title funds) must add services beyond what the school would provide anyway; they cannot pay for what local funds are required to cover.	Treating any grant dollar as flexible money to fill a general budget hole.	A shortfall in a core cost and a pot of restricted grant money.
5	Matching the emergency protocol to the hazard	Evacuate for hazards inside the building (fire), shelter in place for outside environmental hazards (severe weather, chemical release), and lock down for a violent threat in or near the building.	Using one familiar drill for every emergency.	Where the danger is and what kind it is.
6	Structured, lawful hiring	Ask every candidate the same job-related questions scored against preset criteria, and avoid questions about protected traits such as age, religion, family plans, or disability.	Relying on casual conversation or “fit” questions that drift into personal life.	An interview question or a hiring panel's scoring process.
7	IEP decisions belong to the IEP team	Services in an IEP must be delivered as written; changes in services or placement require an IEP team decision with the parent, not an administrator's scheduling choice.	Thinking a principal can reduce services to solve a staffing problem.	A staffing or scheduling fix that would change what an IEP says.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	The negotiated agreement governs working conditions	Before changing duties, hours, or assignments, check the collective bargaining agreement and follow its terms and notice rules.	Assuming administrator authority overrides contract language.	A change to teacher duty time, class load, or assignment.

Course scope (public description): Focus on Instruction and Operations - Practicum in Educational Leadership - Focus on Instruction and Operations provides candidates with an authentic, real-world work experience as an educational leader in a K-12 school environment. This is the second of a two-part experience designed to take place under the leadership and supervision of a practicing school principal or assistant principal at an approved practicum school site (K-12). This course includes an emphasis on the application of knowledge and skills to areas affecting school operations and school personnel. The course also includes the completion of assigned administrative duties in a K-12 setting, as defined by the candidate's state of residence, under the supervision of the cooperating administrator of the candidate's approved practicum site. Prior to enrolling in this practicum course, the candidate must complete a minimum of 18 CUs.